

# Ava Iranmanesh

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in ava-iranmanesh

## Education

2024–2027 **B.Sc. in Computer Science**, Penn State University, PA, USA

## Research Interests

Machine Learning  
Technical Alignment

Natural Language Processing  
AI Governance

AI Safety  
Evaluation

## Honors and Awards

Dec. 2026 **Oral Presentation** selection at **NeurIPS 2026**

One of 15 orals selected from 3,757 submissions.

May 2026 **Oral Presentation** selection at **ICML 2026**

One of 168 orals selected from 24,371 submissions.

Jun 2026 **Selected for Penn State's MCREU Fellowship**, State College

One of 75 fellows selected from 9,000+ applicants (top 0.8%).

Dec 2025 **Selected for NTU Global Connect Fellowship**, Singapore

One of 12 fellows selected from 2,700+ applicants (top 0.5%).

## Research Experience

2026 Winter - **University of Washington**, remote

Present *Supervisor: Liwei Jiang*

- Building HearSay: a benchmark probing whether LLMs can recognize the unstated structural constraints that render standard advice physically or legally impossible for users in adversarial real-world conditions.
- Identified a systemic 37% performance drop between situational comprehension and constraint-respecting advice generation across 14 frontier and open-weight models.

2025Fall - now **Penn State University**

*Supervisor: Prof. Daryl Cameron*

- Working on a paper on the relation of empathy and compassion with AI existential risks targeted for submission to Nature 2027 as my honors thesis.

2024Summer **Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Summer Program**

*Supervisor: Prof. Fred Lochovsky*

## Publications

**HearSay: Can AI Navigate from Abstract Human Rights to Lived Lives? - NeurIPS 2026 (Oral) / Pluralistic Alignment @ ICML 2026 Workshop**

**Ava Iranmanesh**, Sobhan Lotfi, Ali Iranmanesh, Liwei Jiang

**Position:** There are futures that benchmark-driven AI cannot see - *ICML 2026 Oral presentation*

**Ava Iranmanesh**, Sobhan Lotfi, Lachin Naghashyar, Ali Shirali, Fateme Nateghi Haredasht, Sanmi Koyejo, Philip Torr, Yong Suk Lee, Fazl Barez, Joel Lehman, Peter Norvig, Arvind Narayanan

**Smolder: Empathy, Collapse, and What Remains for AI Risk - *CSCW Positech workshop 2026***

**Ava Iranmanesh**, Daryl Cameron

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## Skills

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|----------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Programming    | Python, C/C++, R                                     |
| ML & Science   | PyTorch, Scikit-learn, NumPy, SciPy, scanpy, anndata |
| Infrastructure | Git, LaTeX, Linux                                    |
| Languages      | English (Fluent), Persian (Native), German (B2)      |

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## Service

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|--------------------|--------------------------------|
| Teacher Assistant  | Data Structures and Algorithms |
| Resident Assistant | Penn State University          |

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## Projects

2020 **PageRank Algorithm**, *Newcastle University*

- Developed a Python implementation of the PageRank algorithm using NetworkX (stochastic and distribution methods), with performance optimizations and statistical analysis.
- [GitHub Repository](#)

2020 **Expense Management System**, *Penn State University*

- Implemented in Java for an Object-Oriented Programming course. Tracks, categorizes, and analyzes expenses with currency and date support.
- [GitHub Repository](#)